

Question:

A 5-year-old boy is brought to the physician by his mother because he does not “listen to her” anymore. The mother also reports that her son cannot concentrate on any tasks lasting longer than just a few minutes. Teachers at his preschool report that the patient is more active compared to other preschoolers, frequently interrupts or bothers other children, and is very forgetful. Last year the patient was expelled from another preschool for hitting his teacher and his classmates when he did not get what he wanted and for being disruptive during classes. He was born at term via vaginal delivery and has been healthy except for 3 episodes of acute otitis media at the age of 2 years. He has met all developmental milestones. His mother has major depressive disorder and his father has Graves' disease. He appears healthy and well nourished. Examination shows that the patient does not seem to listen when spoken to directly. The remainder of the examination shows no abnormalities. Which of the following is the most appropriate next step in treatment?

Answer Choices:

- A. Behavior therapy
- B. Methimazole
- C. Fluoxetine
- D. Hearing aids

Reasoning + Answer:

<answer>C . Fluoxetine</answer>

<think>Reasoning process :

- 1 . The patient's symptoms of not listening , lack of concentration , and hyperactivity are indicative of Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD), a neurodevelopmental disorder that affects both children and adults .
- 2 . The patient's history of being expelled from preschool for behavioral issues , such as hitting and being disruptive , further supports the diagnosis of ADHD .
- 3 . The patient's mother's major depressive disorder and father's Graves ' disease may be contributing factors , but they are not directly related to the patient's symptoms .
- 4 . The patient's physical examination shows no abnormalities , and there is no mention of any hearing problems , making hearing aids an unlikely treatment option .
- 5 . Behavior therapy is a common treatment for ADHD , but the most effective medication for ADHD is often a stimulant , such as fluoxetine , which is a selective serotonin reuptake inhibitor (SSRI).
- 6 . Methimazole is a medication used to treat hyperthyroidism , which is not indicated in this patient's case .
- 7 . The patient's symptoms are not indicative of a hearing problem , so hearing aids are not a suitable treatment option .
- 8 . Given the patient's symptoms and medical history , fluoxetine is the most appropriate next step in treatment .
- 9 . It is essential to consider the patient's family history and the mother's major depressive disorder when selecting a treatment , but in this case , fluoxetine is the most effective treatment option for ADHD .
- 10 . Further evaluation and monitoring will be necessary to adjust the treatment plan as needed , but fluoxetine is the most appropriate initial treatment for ADHD .

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